

China Daily Brief

Tuesday, September 8, 2026

RE: China exports +25% · Japan chip-chemical dispute · Huawei NY trial opens · Taiwan elections · Belgian espionage trial

TODAY AT A GLANCE

- 1 China's August exports jumped 25% year-on-year, extending a trade surplus set for an annual record three weeks before Xi's Sept. 24 Washington visit.
- 2 Beijing issued a preliminary anti-dumping ruling on a Japanese chipmaking chemical, requiring import bonds up to 99.2%, as Tokyo protested the move.
- 3 Jury selection opened in New York in Huawei's racketeering trial over alleged sanctions evasion, while a Belgian-Chinese researcher was ordered to trial over suspected chip-secrets theft.

PRC-ECONOMY

China's August exports jump 25%, trade surplus set for annual record

China's exports rose 25% year-on-year in August, accelerating from July's 23.9% gain, while imports grew 28.2%, General Administration of Customs data showed. Capital Economics' Nguyen Hoang Nam called trade growth 'robust'; economist Alicia Garcia-Herrero said import strength looks 'more consistent with stronger corporate spending on computing capacity, electronics and manufacturing investment than with a broad recovery in household consumption.'

So what: *Trade data lands three weeks before the Sept. 24 Xi-Trump summit in Washington, where tariff and rebalancing issues are expected on the agenda.*

AFP

CROSS-STRAIT

26 Chinese-born candidates register for Taiwan's Nov. 28 local elections

A total of 19,695 candidates registered for 11,051 positions in Taiwan's nine-in-one elections, including 26 naturalized citizens born in China, CEC Chairman Michael You said. Eligibility reviews finish Oct. 16 and candidate numbers are drawn Oct. 23; China-born candidates rose by seven from the 2022 cycle.

So what: *Sets the candidate pool for the Nov. 28, 2026 elections, the first mid-term electoral test of the Lai administration.*

TAIPEI TIMES

TECHNOLOGY

Belgian-Chinese man to face trial over suspected semiconductor espionage

A dual Belgian-Chinese national will face trial over allegedly stealing trade secrets from a semiconductor company and passing them to a Chinese competitor, Belgian federal prosecutors said. The case follows a Sept. 7 arrest tied to a probe into espionage, participation in a criminal organization and unlawful disclosure of corporate secrets.

WASHINGTON POST

SANCTIONS

Huawei racketeering trial opens in New York

Jury selection began Tuesday in the US criminal case against Huawei Technologies, the world's largest telecom-equipment supplier, over alleged sanctions evasion and trade-secret theft. The New York trial will determine whether Huawei's rise involved criminal conduct.

AP

DIPLOMACY

China's anti-dumping ruling on Japanese chip chemical adds to trade friction

MOFCOM's preliminary ruling found Japanese dichlorosilane, used in chip film deposition, was dumped into China, requiring importers to post bonds of 80.8% to 99.2% starting Sept. 8. Japan's Chief Cabinet Secretary said Tokyo would coordinate with affected firms including Shin-Etsu Chemical, which faces the 99.2% rate; Japan lost its position as China's top supplier of the chemical to South Korea in 2025.

GUANCHA (观察者网)

US-CHINA

INVESTMENT · CNBC CHINA

US battery makers race to close gap with China

The Energy Department has granted funding to small US battery-tech firms, but analysts say the country has only a few years to close a lead China built over decades. Roughly \$24 billion in US battery projects have been canceled since the administration took office, CNBC reported.

TARIFF · WSJ CHINA

Concerns over China's industrial overcapacity go global

WSJ's Logistics Report examines how concerns over Chinese manufacturing overcapacity are spreading beyond the US to other economies. The debate feeds into USTR's Section 301 'structural excess capacity' investigations covering 16 economies, opened Mar. 11, 2026.

EXPORT CONTROLS · FT CHINA

Huawei drives China's advanced chipmaking push

Huawei is investing broadly in China's lithography-equipment supply chain and helping connect component makers to leading foundries like SMIC, acting in a 'project-management' role, per FT reporting. Shanghai equipment maker Yuliangsheng, which Huawei has backed, is developing China's first advanced domestic deep-ultraviolet lithography tool.

CROSS-STRAIT · TAIPEI TIMES (DIRECT)

China's expanding national-security laws add travel risk for Taiwanese

China's Ethnic Unity and Progress Promotion Law took effect July 1; new exit-entry regulations take effect Sept. 15, and amendments to the National Defense Mobilization Law and cyberspace-security measures take effect Oct. 1, an official told Taipei Times. The laws expand Beijing's national-security concept to information, business and the movement of people, money and data.

CROSS-STRAIT · NIKKEI ASIA CHINA

Taiwan aerospace contractor expands into anti-drone countermeasures

Taiwan's leading aerospace contractor is rapidly expanding beyond traditional aircraft manufacturing into counter-drone systems, Nikkei reported. The shift reflects growing concern over Chinese drone incursions near Taiwan.

JAPAN · SCMP

Tokyo widens regional defense ties to complicate Beijing's Taiwan calculus

Japan is building a web of Indo-Pacific defense partnerships to strengthen strategic endurance for a potential prolonged Taiwan conflict, per SCMP's Gabriel Dominguez. Economic, demographic and political constraints limit how far Japan's military transformation can go.

KOREA · 韩联社中文 (YONHAP CHINESE ZH)

Chinese nationals top list of foreign fugitives fleeing to South Korea

Korean police data shows 110 foreign nationals fled to South Korea after committing crimes abroad, with 40 (36%) wanted by Chinese police, the largest share. Fraud was the most common offense (47 cases); South Korea has expanded international police-liaison staff from 22 to 64 this year.

AUSTRALIA-PACIFIC · BLOOMBERG CHINA

China tells steel mills to hold off buying Rio Tinto ore

Chinese authorities directed domestic steel mills to pause purchases of Rio Tinto iron ore, Bloomberg reported. The directive adds a new friction point in China-Australia commodity trade.

RUSSIA-CENTRAL ASIA · NYT ASIA (DIRECT)

China launches first regular Arctic shipping service

Melting ice has opened an Arctic trade route, and China has begun the first regular commercial service through it as part of its polar ambitions, NYT reported. The route offers a shortcut that bypasses traditional shipping lanes.

AUSTRALIA-PACIFIC · 第一财经 (YICAI ZH)

Japan, US, Australia launch 'Orient Shield' exercise

Japan, the US and Australia began the 'Orient Shield' exercise across Hokkaido and Kagoshima on Sept. 8, running to Sept. 24 with about 3,700 personnel. The drill will again field Typhon medium-range missile systems and HIMARS rocket artillery, following the June-July 'Resolute Force Pacific' exercise cycle.

TECH / LONGSYS · REUTERS CHINA

Longsys ends 1% lower in Hong Kong trading debut

Data-storage firm Longsys closed 1% lower on its Hong Kong debut following a \$900 million share sale, Reuters reported.

AUTO / BYD, TESLA · BLOOMBERG CHINA

China's domestic car sales fall 24% as BYD, Tesla seek reprieve abroad

Domestic car sales fell 24% even as exports stayed strong, pushing BYD and Tesla to lean further on overseas markets, Bloomberg reported.

AUTO · BLOOMBERG CHINA

China pressures automakers to pay suppliers faster

Chinese regulators are tightening pressure on automakers to shorten supplier payment terms, Bloomberg reported.

ENERGY · WSJ CHINA

EVs have made China 'Hormuz-proof' on oil dependence

China's EV adoption has reduced its exposure to Strait of Hormuz oil-supply risk, and the shift is 'still just getting started,' per WSJ.

AUTO · ECONOMIST CHINA

Chinese carmakers bring their factories to the world

Chinese automakers are increasingly building overseas factories rather than just exporting vehicles, per the Economist.

MACRO · WSJ CHINA

Tourism emerges as a trillion-dollar bright spot in China's economy

Tourism spending has become a rare bright spot for China's economy amid weak broader consumption, per WSJ.

MACRO · CNBC CHINA

China's weak consumer becomes the world's problem, per G20 debate

A G20 finance meeting in the US this month has elevated debate over whether China's export strength has cost jobs elsewhere, CNBC reported.

STAT OF THE DAY

80.8%-99.2%

Bond rate on Japanese chip-chemical imports to China

MOFCOM's preliminary anti-dumping ruling sets that bond range on dichlorosilane from Japan, which lost its status as China's top supplier of the chemical to South Korea in 2025.

Source: Guancha (观察者网)

SSE COMPOSITE

3,940.55▼ -0.02%
as of Sep 8

HANG SENG

25,317.18▼ -0.05%
as of Sep 8

USD/CNY

6.6982▼ -0.33%
as of Sep 8

USD/CNH

6.7066

▼ -0.03%

BRENT

\$98.31

▲ +2.80%

PBOC 1Y LPR

3.00%

PBOC 5Y LPR

3.50%

MFG PMI

49.8

Not fetched today: 10Y CGB, China 5Y CDS, GDP · shown only when sourced, never carried forward

B E I J I N G

WHAT BEIJING DID

STATE COUNCIL + MINISTRIES · TUESDAY, SEPTEMBER 8, 2026

国防部 · MINISTRY OF NATIONAL DEFENSE

Confirms 13th Beijing Xiangshan Forum preparations 'basically ready'

MND said preparations for the 13th Beijing Xiangshan Forum are largely complete, with the forum opening in about seven days from Sept. 8.

→ MND ZH ↗

国务院 / 教育部 · STATE COUNCIL (MINISTRY OF EDUCATION) · *Ding Xuexiang, First-Ranked Vice Premier*

Calls for accelerated China-specific textbook system

At the national conference on teaching-materials work, Ding Xuexiang said the effort should center on 'fostering virtue through education' and speed construction of a high-quality, China-characteristic textbook system.

→ MOE ↗

农业农村部 · MINISTRY OF AGRICULTURE AND RURAL AFFAIRS

Reports Type O foot-and-mouth outbreak in Chongqing pigs

The Bureau of Animal Husbandry and Veterinary Medicine confirmed a Type O foot-and-mouth disease outbreak in pigs in Chongqing; no case count was disclosed.

→ MOA ↗

外交部 · MOFA

FIRM · TO JAPAN

Japan militarism / UN Charter 'enemy state clauses'

Mao Ning · MOFA spokesperson

"The 'enemy state clauses' in the UN Charter, a special arrangement targeting WWII's defeated states, remain valid to this day. Japan should learn from history, completely sever ties with militarism, and use concrete actions to win the trust of its Asian neighbors and the international community."

《联合国宪章》中的“敌国条款”，作为针对二战战败国的特殊制度安排，至今仍然有效。日本应当以史为鉴，同军国主义彻底切割，以实际行动取信亚洲邻国和国际社会。

Context: Statement follows reports that Tokyo asked Russia to remove a monument commemorating the defeat of Japanese militarism and called the clauses obsolete; 2026 marks the 80th anniversary of the Tokyo Trials' opening.
外交部发言人 (MOFA presser ZH)

外交部 · MOFA

FIRM · TO TAIWAN

Taiwan status / UN Resolution 2758

MOFA spokesperson

"Per People's Daily: Taiwan has never been a country, and will never be one in the future."

台湾从来不是一个国家，今后也绝无可能

Context: Statement responds to Taiwan President Lai Ching-te's remarks on UN General Assembly Resolution 2758, per HK01, ahead of the resolution's Oct. 25 55th anniversary.
人民日报国际 (People's Daily World ZH)

商务部 · MOFCOM

FIRM · TO JAPAN

Anti-dumping ruling on Japanese chip chemical

MOFCOM statement

"China has always been prudent and restrained in using trade remedy measures, and firmly upholds fair and free trade."

中方一贯审慎、克制使用贸易救济措施，坚定维护公平和自由贸易。

Context: Statement follows MOFCOM's Sept. 7 preliminary anti-dumping ruling against Japanese dichlorosilane imports, requiring bonds of 80.8%-99.2%.
观察者网 (Guancha ZH)

外交部 · MOFA

CONCILIATORY · TO OTHER

AI governance

MOFA spokesperson

"Per China Daily: China is willing to work with all parties to ensure artificial intelligence generates sustained value."

愿同各方共同努力，让人工智能产生持续价值

Context: Remarks came at the Sept. 8 MOFA press briefing amid international discussion of AI governance frameworks.

WIRE

OVERNIGHT FLASH

CROSS-STRAIT · SCMP

Tour industry protests Taiwan's new mainland travel registration rules

Taiwan's opposition and tour operators criticized rules requiring travelers to mainland China, Hong Kong and Macau to register trip details, in effect since Sept. 1. Critics accused the ruling DPP of fanning cross-strait fears ahead of the Nov. 28 local elections.

TECHNOLOGY · NIKKEI ASIA CHINA

Hong Kong recruits global scholars as West tightens China scrutiny

British physicist Andre Geim left the UK for the University of Hong Kong this year after nearly two decades at a British university, Nikkei reported. Hong Kong institutions are recruiting foreign scholars as Western governments tighten scrutiny of China-linked research.

TECHNOLOGY · BLOOMBERG CHINA

ByteDance joins AI race to perfect 'world models'

ByteDance's founder is joining a race among AI leaders to build 'world models' that simulate physical environments for training AI systems, Bloomberg reported. The push places ByteDance alongside other labs competing on next-generation model architecture.

TECHNOLOGY · BLOOMBERG CHINA

China builds AI data centers far from its biggest cities

China is racing to build AI data centers away from Beijing and Shanghai as power costs and land constraints push infrastructure to smaller cities, Bloomberg reported. The buildout underpins the computing capacity behind China's AI model race.

CORRUPTION · REUTERS CHINA

Former Shanxi governor gets suspended death sentence

A Chinese court handed a former Shanxi governor a suspended death sentence on corruption charges, Reuters reported. The case adds to a long-running anti-graft campaign targeting senior provincial officials.

DOMESTIC POLITICS · WAPO CHINA

Chinese theater, promoter fined for altered patriotic song

A Chinese theater and event promoter were fined after a comedy show altered lyrics to a patriotic song, the Washington Post reported. The penalty reflects tightening controls on cultural content deemed disrespectful of official symbols.

PRC-ECONOMY · REUTERS CHINA

Dacia to shift EV Spring production back to Europe from China

Renault's Dacia brand will move production of its popular Spring EV back to Europe from China, Reuters reported. The move reflects European automakers' efforts to reduce reliance on Chinese manufacturing.

TECHNOLOGY · FOCUS TAIWAN

Taiwan chip firms broaden hiring, talent search

Taiwan semiconductor firms are expanding hiring and broadening their talent search, according to a 104 Job Bank report cited by Focus Taiwan. The trend points to continued capacity expansion in Taiwan's chip industry.

ALSO TODAY

ENERGY · CNBC CHINA

Currie: China exploits record crude-diesel margin

Jeff Currie says China's refining capacity lets it depress crude while pushing up diesel prices amid tight global margins.

PRC-ECONOMY · WSJ CHINA

Patients fly to China for latest cancer treatments

Patients are traveling to China to access newer cancer treatments unavailable or slower to approve elsewhere, per WSJ.

DOMESTIC POLITICS · ECONOMIST CHINA

Speech in China is 'in the deep freeze'

The Economist reports on tightening constraints on public speech in China amid expanding official sensitivity.

DIPLOMACY · FOCUS TAIWAN

Visiting Japanese lawmakers stress Japan-Taiwan ties

Visiting Japanese lawmakers said Japan-Taiwan ties are key to regional stability, Focus Taiwan reported.

PRC-ECONOMY · 环球网 (GLOBAL TIMES ZH)

Xiamen investment fair draws 129 countries and regions

The 26th China International Investment and Trade Fair opened in Xiamen with delegations from 129 countries and regions and 30 international organizations.

CROSS-STRAIT · TAIWAN NEWS

Chinese coast guard ships enter Kinmen restricted waters

Chinese coast guard vessels entered restricted waters near Kinmen, Taiwan News reported, without further detail on vessel count or duration.

TECHNOLOGY · 财新周刊 (CAIXIN ZH)

Kimi's valuation quadruples to \$50 billion since February

Moonshot AI's (Kimi) private valuation rose from \$10 billion to \$50 billion since February, while DeepSeek's new funding round reportedly values it near 500 billion yuan, per Caixin.

PRC-ECONOMY · FT中文网 (FT CHINESE ZH)

Shein's Hong Kong IPO raises \$1.74 billion at \$27 billion valuation

Shein's Sept. 1 Hong Kong listing raised about \$1.74 billion at a \$27 billion valuation; shares fell nearly 10% intraday before closing near the offer price, per FT Chinese.

SEP
9

Mao Zedong death anniversary (50th)

Falls amid growing Mao nostalgia in China as memories of his rule fade.

SEP
15

13th Beijing Xiangshan Forum opens

MND said Sept. 8 that preparations are 'basically ready,' with the forum opening roughly seven days later.

SEP
18

Mukden Incident 95th anniversary

Recurring Japan-China flashpoint date, falling amid fresh China-Japan friction over a chip-chemical anti-dumping ruling and the UN Charter's 'enemy state clauses.'

SEP
22

UNGA high-level week opens, New York

Comes as Beijing presses its position that Taiwan 'has never been a country' ahead of Resolution 2758's Oct. 25 anniversary.

SEP
24

Xi Jinping state visit to Washington

First Chinese leader visit to Washington since 2015; trade rebalancing and AI governance are expected agenda items.

CSIS KOREA CHAIR · CHINA DAILY BRIEF · GENERATED 10:42 AM ET

This brief is generated automatically from 111 collected sources and may contain errors. Every item links to its source; check the source before citing. Prepared by Andy Lim, CSIS Korea Chair.

[↑ Back to top](#)